

SORCERER

A Concise 400-Point Walkthrough

Infocom, Release 15 / Serial 851108 (stories/sorcerer.z3), played on the zAI-Machine interpreter with random seed 42. Final result: **400 of a possible 400, in 587 moves** — *Leader of the Circle of Enchanters*. Every command below is replayed by `SorcererWalkthroughTests.Sorcerer_PerfectScore`.

Written during play using only the game's Popular Enchanting folio as a reference.

Know Before You Go

- **Seed-dependent values.** Three things are random per game: the trunk code ("orc" here: red, gray, purple, gray, red), the coal mine dial combination (3), and the casino jackpot (pull 25). On another seed you must rediscover them.
- **Memory is short.** About five spells at once; sleep erases them. Memorize right before you need them.
- **Everything is on a clock.** Locusts (3 turns), the crumbling river bank, the returning flood, fwep (~14 moves), vilstu (~26 turns) and fatigue all bite. The command order below is tuned to these limits.
- **Death is survivable once** if you cast GASPAR beforehand — you revive at Egreth Castle, but lose your belongings.
- **Keep the spell book dry.** Water ruins it permanently, and you can only climb the coal chute rope with empty hands.

The Walkthrough

1. The Guild Hall (score after: 75)

Belboz is missing. Order a potion by mail before the messenger comes, gather what he left behind, and open the trunk.

Command	What happens / why	Pts
FROTZ SPELL BOOK, GET UP, W, S, S, W, TAKE MATCHBOOK, E	Wake from the hellhound dream; light your book.	+5
OPEN RECEPTACLE, PUT MATCHBOOK IN RECEPTACLE, CLOSE RECEPTACLE	Mails the vilstu order before the messenger arrives.	
N, W, TAKE SCROLL, GNUSTO GASPAR	Helistar's room: GASPAR (resurrection).	
E, N, W, OPEN DESK, LOOK BEHIND HANGING	A key falls out.	+15
TAKE KEY, TAKE ALL FROM DESK, OPEN JOURNAL, READ JOURNAL	"Current code: orc."	
OPEN TINY BOX, TAKE AMULET, then drop key, box, journal, infotater	The amulet glows near Belboz.	
E, S, S, E, TAKE SCROLL, GNUSTO MEEF	Library: MEEF (wilt plants).	+10
W, W, TAKE OCHRE VIAL, OPEN IT, DRINK OCHRE POTION	Berzio: no more hunger or thirst.	+10
E, OPEN RECEPTACLE, TAKE ORANGE VIAL	Vilstu (no breathing) has arrived.	+10
D, PUSH RED/GRAY/PURPLE/GRAY/RED BUTTON, TAKE MOLDY SCROLL	The trunk opens: AIMFIZ.	+25

2. Following Belboz (score after: 115)

AIMFIZ drops you into your dream. Run before the hellhound arrives, then plunder the fort and river cave.

Command	What happens / why	Pts
LEARN GASPAR, YOMIN, IZYUK, PULVER; U; GASPAR	Provide for your resurrection first.	
AIMFIZ BELBOZ, NE	Twisted Forest; the hellhound stops at the Forest Edge.	+20
E, NE, SE, E, LOWER FLAG, EXAMINE FLAG, TAKE AQUA VIAL	Fooble potion hidden in the flag.	
W, NW, PULVER RIVER, D, NE, TAKE ALL, GNUSTO FWEED	Hidden Cave: FWEED, amber vial (blort), bat guano.	+20
D, SW, D, W, SW, SW	Pit of Bones, dungeon, highway, crater.	

3. The Fort Cannon and the Zorkmid Tree (score after: 140)

Guano sends the cannon's scroll-mimics running; fly past the eroding river bank.

Command	What happens / why	Pts
N, SLEEP, U, U, LEARN IZYUK, E, IZYUK ME, NE, SE, E, E	Sleep in the Slimy Room; fly so the bank can't collapse.	
PUT GUANO IN CANNON, TAKE ORDINARY SCROLL	YONK (augment a spell) — too powerful to copy.	+10
W, W, LEARN IZYUK, IZYUK ME, NW, SW, W, D, D, S	Back through the Snake Pit to the Crater.	
LEARN IZYUK, W, IZYUK ME, W, W, N, TAKE COIN	Fly the chasm; the illusory tree yields one zorkmid.	+15
S, E, LEARN IZYUK, IZYUK ME, E, E, S, SW	Back to the Park Entrance.	

4. Bozbarland (score after: 170)

One coin gets you into the park; a steady arm wins a spell; the slot machine pays for the toll.

Command	What happens / why	Pts
W, GIVE COIN TO GNOME, W, W, S	Arcade.	
OPEN AQUA VIAL, DRINK AQUA POTION, TAKE BALL, THROW BALL AT BUNNY	Fooble steadies your aim: MALYON.	+10
N, W, PULL LEVER (x25), TAKE COIN	Three hot pepper sandwiches pay out (seed 42).	
E, E, E, NE, N, NE, NE, E, E, WAKE GNOME, GIVE COIN TO GNOME, E	Through the toll gate.	+20

5. The Glass Maze (score after: 215)

An invisible 3×3×3 maze with missing floors. As a bat you sense walls; rest on floored cells when FWEED ends.

Command	What happens / why	Pts
E, WAIT (x10), SLEEP, N, N, LEARN FWEED (x5)	Sleep first — the round trip is long.	
FWEED, E, N, E, S, S, W, D, E, E, N, N, WAIT, WAIT	First hop; land on a floored cell.	
FWEED, U, U, S, E, WAIT (x5)	The Hollow.	+20
TAKE SCROLL, PUT SCROLL IN HOLE	SWANZO drops down the chimney. The maze shifts and a dorn beast charges.	
FWEED, W, W, S, E, D, D, W, W, WAIT (x3)	Lure the beast over a floorless cell; it falls.	
FWEED, U, U, N, N, D, E, S, E, N, D, W, S, W, WAIT	Through the reshaped maze.	
FWEED, U, W, WAIT (x6), TAKE ALL, S, S, E	Back at the arch; walk to the Stone Hut.	
DROP ORDINARY SCROLL, TAKE PARCHMENT SCROLL, GNUSTO SWANZO, TAKE ORDINARY SCROLL, SLEEP	From the fireplace.	+25

6. The Dragon and the Coal Mine Time Loop (score after: 320)

The heart of the game: you meet yourself. Your younger self replays everything you did on your first visit.

Command	What happens / why	Pts
W (x5), SW, SW, S, S, LEARN MALYON, YONK MALYON, MALYON DRAGON, S	<i>The carving comes to life and opens the Sooty Room.</i>	+20
FROTZ AMULET, LEARN MEEF (x2), LEARN SWANZO, DROP AMBER VIAL	<i>Worn light — you'll need empty hands later.</i>	
OPEN ORANGE VIAL, DRINK ORANGE POTION, E, DROP ORANGE VIAL, LOOK	<i>Vilstu vs. coal gas. Your older self slides out of the chute and gasps "The combination is 3."</i>	
GIVE BOOK TO TWIN	<i>He'll hand it back later — dry.</i>	
E, TURN DIAL TO 3, OPEN DOOR		+20
E, TAKE ROPE, U, NE, N, SW, TAKE BEAM, NW, W	<i>Top of the chute.</i>	
TIE ROPE TO BEAM, PUT BEAM ACROSS CHUTE, PUT ROPE IN CHUTE, CLIMB DOWN ROPE	<i>Slanted Room (only worn items allowed).</i>	+20
TAKE SCROLL, GOLMAC ME, OPEN LAMP, TAKE SMELLY SCROLL	<i>Travel back a few minutes; VARDIK waits in the lamp.</i>	+25
E, YOUNGER SELF, THE COMBINATION IS 3, WAIT, DOWN	<i>Close the loop; your younger self hands back the book. Lagoon Shore.</i>	+20

7. Jeearr (score after: 400)

Collect the grue suit, pass the grues, and shield your own mind before driving the demon out of Belboz.

Command	What happens / why	Pts
GNUSTO VARDIK, WAIT, WAIT (you collapse and sleep)		
LEARN MEEF (x2), DROP BOOK, E, D, MEEF SPENSEWEEDS, OPEN CRATE, TAKE SUIT AND REPELLENT	<i>The book must never go underwater.</i>	+15
U, W, TAKE BOOK, NE, N, MEEF VINES, W, W	<i>The mutated grues ignore a grue.</i>	+20
LEARN VARDIK, LEARN SWANZO, OPEN WHITE DOOR	<i>Belboz's Hideout.</i>	+20
VARDIK ME, SWANZO BELBOZ	<i>Jeearr finds no host and dissipates.</i>	+25

Scoring

Event	Pts	Total
Waking up	5	5
Key behind the wall hanging	15	20
MEEF scroll	10	30
Berzio potion	10	40
Vilstu potion delivered	10	50
Opening the trunk	25	75
AIMFIZ to Belboz	20	95
Hidden Cave	20	115
YONK scroll from the cannon	10	125
Zorkmid coin	15	140
MALYON prize	10	150
Passing the toll gate	20	170
Reaching the Hollow	20	190
SWANZO scroll	25	215
Waking the dragon carving	20	235
Opening the dial door	20	255
Slanted Room	20	275
VARDIK scroll (time loop)	25	300
Escaping to the lagoon	20	320
Grue crate	15	335
Mammoth Cavern	20	355
Belboz's Hideout	20	375
Exorcising Jeearr	25	400

Spells

Spell	Effect	Source
GNUSTO/REZROV/FROTZ	<i>Permanent spells</i>	<i>Starting</i>
VEZZA, PULVER, IZYUK, YOMIN	<i>View future; dry liquids; fly; mind probe</i>	<i>Starting book</i>
GASPAR	<i>Provide for your resurrection</i>	<i>Helistar's quarters</i>
MEEF	<i>Wilt plants</i>	<i>Guild library</i>
AIMFIZ	<i>Travel to a person (one shot)</i>	<i>Cellar trunk</i>
FWEEP	<i>Turn into a bat</i>	<i>Hidden Cave</i>
YONK	<i>Augment a spell (one shot)</i>	<i>Fort cannon</i>

Spell	Effect	Source
MALYON	<i>Bring objects to life</i>	<i>Arcade prize</i>
SWANZO	<i>Exorcise an inhabiting presence</i>	<i>The Hollow</i>
GOLMAC	<i>Travel in time (one shot)</i>	<i>Slanted Room</i>
VARDIK	<i>Shield a mind from evil spirits</i>	<i>Kerosene lamp (in the past)</i>

Full Command List

One line per turn, exactly as replayed by the test (seed 42). Read down each column.

1	verbose	86	up	171	east	256	wait
2	wait	87	up	172	east	257	take all
3	frotz spell book	88	learn izyuk	173	wake gnome	258	south
4	get up	89	east	174	give coin to gnome	259	south
5	west	90	izyuk me	175	east	260	east
6	south	91	ne	176	east	261	drop ordinary scroll
7	south	92	se	177	wait	262	take parchment scroll
8	west	93	east	178	wait	263	gnusto swanzo
9	take matchbook	94	east	179	wait	264	take ordinary scroll
10	east	95	put guano in cannon	180	wait	265	sleep
11	open receptacle	96	look in cannon	181	wait	266	west
12	put matchbook in receptacle	97	take ordinary scroll	182	wait	267	west
13	close receptacle	98	read ordinary scroll	183	wait	268	west
14	north	99	gnusto yonk	184	wait	269	west
15	west	100	west	185	wait	270	west
16	take scroll	101	west	186	wait	271	sw
17	gnusto gaspar	102	learn izyuk	187	sleep	272	sw
18	east	103	izyuk me	188	north	273	south
19	north	104	nw	189	north	274	south
20	west	105	sw	190	learn fweep	275	learn malyon
21	open desk	106	west	191	learn fweep	276	yonk malyon
22	look behind hanging	107	down	192	learn fweep	277	malyon dragon
23	take key	108	down	193	learn fweep	278	south
24	take all from desk	109	south	194	learn fweep	279	frotz amulet
25	open journal	110	learn izyuk	195	fweep	280	learn meef
26	read journal	111	west	196	east	281	learn meef
27	open tiny box	112	izyuk me	197	north	282	learn swanzo
28	take amulet	113	west	198	east	283	drop amber vial
29	drop key	114	west	199	south	284	open orange vial
30	drop tiny box	115	north	200	south	285	drink orange potion
31	drop journal	116	take coin	201	west	286	east
32	drop infotater	117	south	202	down	287	drop orange vial
33	east	118	east	203	east	288	look
34	south	119	learn izyuk	204	east	289	give book to twin
35	south	120	izyuk me	205	north	290	east
36	east	121	east	206	north	291	turn dial to 3
37	take scroll	122	east	207	wait	292	open door
38	gnusto meef	123	south	208	wait	293	east
39	west	124	sw	209	fweep	294	take rope
40	west	125	west	210	up	295	up
41	take ochre vial	126	give coin to gnome	211	up	296	ne
42	open ochre vial	127	west	212	south	297	north
43	drink ochre potion	128	west	213	east	298	sw
44	drop ochre vial	129	south	214	wait	299	take beam
45	east	130	open aqua vial	215	wait	300	nw
46	open receptacle	131	drink aqua potion	216	wait	301	west
47	take orange vial	132	take ball	217	wait	302	tie rope to beam
48	read orange vial	133	throw ball at bunny	218	wait	303	put beam across chute
49	down	134	gnusto malyon	219	take scroll	304	put rope in chute
50	push red button	135	drop aqua vial	220	put scroll in hole	305	climb down rope
51	push gray button	136	north	221	fweep	306	take scroll
52	push purple button	137	west	222	west	307	golmac me
53	push gray button	138	pull lever	223	west	308	open lamp
54	push red button	139	pull lever	224	south	309	take smelly scroll
55	take moldy scroll	140	pull lever	225	east	310	east
56	learn gaspar	141	pull lever	226	down	311	younger self, the combination is 3
57	learn yomin	142	pull lever	227	down	312	wait
58	learn izyuk	143	pull lever	228	west	313	down
59	learn pulver	144	pull lever	229	west	314	gnusto vardik
60	up	145	pull lever	230	wait	315	wait
61	gaspar	146	pull lever	231	wait	316	wait
62	aimfiz belboz	147	pull lever	232	wait	317	learn meef
63	ne	148	pull lever	233	fweep	318	learn meef
64	east	149	pull lever	234	up	319	drop book
65	ne	150	pull lever	235	up	320	east
66	se	151	pull lever	236	north	321	down
67	east	152	pull lever	237	north	322	meef spenseweeds
68	lower flag	153	pull lever	238	down	323	open crate
69	examine flag	154	pull lever	239	east	324	take suit and repellent
70	take aqua vial	155	pull lever	240	south	325	up
71	west	156	pull lever	241	east	326	west
72	nw	157	pull lever	242	north	327	take book
73	pulver river	158	pull lever	243	down	328	ne
74	down	159	pull lever	244	west	329	north
75	ne	160	pull lever	245	south	330	meef vines
76	take all	161	pull lever	246	west	331	west
77	gnusto fweep	162	pull lever	247	wait	332	west
78	down	163	take coin	248	fweep	333	learn vardik
79	sw	164	east	249	up	334	learn swanzo
80	down	165	east	250	west	335	open white door
81	west	166	east	251	wait	336	vardik me
82	sw	167	ne	252	wait	337	swanzo belboz
83	sw	168	north	253	wait		
84	north	169	ne	254	wait		
85	sleep	170	ne	255	wait		